

CSS with minor mobile extensions. Newer microbrowsers are full-featured Web browsers capable of HTML, WML, i-mode HTML, cHTML, plus CSS, ECMAScript, and plug-ins such as Macromedia Flash.

So-called microbrowser technologies such as WAP, NTTDocomo's i-mode platform, and Openwave's HDML platform have fuelled the first wave of interest in wireless data services.

HitchHiker is believed to have been the first microbrowser with a unified rendering model, handling HTML and WAP along with EcmaScript, WMLScript, POP3 and IMAP mail in a single client. Although it was not used, it was possible to combine HTML and WAP in the same pages although this would render the pages invalid for any other device. In 1999, Microsoft acquired it, and HitchHiker became Microsoft Mobile Explorer 2.0, not related to the primitive Microsoft Mobile Explorer 1.0.

Released in 2001, Mobile Explorer 3.0 added iMode compatibility (cHTML) plus numerous proprietary schemes. Mobile Explorer development had ceased by mid-2002 and various other microbrowsers by phone vendors made headway in the market and was replaced by the Pocket Internet Explorer.

As mentioned earlier, not only do microbrowsers need to be small in file size, the display screen is also much smaller. Extreme care and meticulous detail must be considered in displaying HTML information onto such a small screen. Bandwidth is also extremely limited and so is the stability. Connections get cut off as with ordinary cell phones and PDAs that are wirelessly connected.

The following are some of the more popular microbrowsers. Some microbrowsers are really miniaturised Web browsers. Hence, some microbrowser makers also provide browsers for the PC.